localized Internet cut offs, and the use of president's rule to bypass the assembly. Over the subsequent years, improvements in the Kashmir Valley such as local elections, higher tourism, and improved law and order were seen in New Delhi as a vindication of its move.

No sooner had the controversy over Article 370 died down than India passed a Citizenship Amendment Act. CAA did not affect existing citizens' status, but created a fast-track for religious minorities from Afghanistan, Pakistan, and Bangladesh. These minorities were specified, with Muslims noticeably excluded. Defenders saw this as rectifying some of the wrongs of Partition and the Nehru–Liaquat Pact. Critics argued that it would set a bad precedent and be used alongside a proposed National Register of Citizens to discriminate against Muslims. [35] CAA resulted in sizeable protests in India, which also invited international attention, but India took the view that other countries—including the United States and Europe—had regularly created selective pathways for citizenship.

Finally, the government passed Farm Laws intended to reduce corruption in agriculture by giving farmers more access to markets, and marginalizing middlemen. Ironically, such measures had long been requested by developed economies who believed India's agricultural policies were distortionary. Nonetheless, the Farm Laws generated protests led by some farmers, especially some communities in North India in and around Punjab and Haryana. It became an issue in already divisive local politics and also led to the mobilization of diaspora groups, including some Sikh communities in the United States, Canada, and the United Kingdom. Much of the international coverage mischaracterized both the laws and the nature of protests. But eventually, concerned about the national security implications, the government retracted the Farm Laws. Thus, between May 2019 and March 2020, India's focus was on domestic priorities that assumed an international dimension.